GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

Ministry of Culture

Preserving Heritage, Inspiring Generations

Confidential and Proprietory
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SHRI NARENDRA MODI

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA



MESSAGE

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SHRI GAJENDRA SINGH SHEKAWAT

HONORABLE MINISTER, MINISTRY OF CULTURE



MESSAGE

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MESSAGE

India's rich cultural heritage, diverse traditions, languages, arts, literature, and historical legacy represent one of the nation's greatest strengths. The Ministry of Culture plays a pivotal role in preserving this invaluable heritage while promoting cultural exchange, creative industries, heritage tourism, digital preservation, and the global recognition of India's civilizational identity. As India moves towards becoming a leading global economy, culture continues to serve as a bridge connecting economic development with social cohesion and national pride.

The Chamber of Commerce and Industries of India (CCI India) recognizes that the cultural sector offers significant opportunities for economic growth through heritage conservation, creative entrepreneurship, cultural tourism, handicrafts, performing arts, digital technologies, and public-private partnerships. By fostering collaboration among government institutions, cultural organizations, industry, investors, startups, academic institutions, and artisans, CCI India seeks to contribute to the sustainable development of India's cultural ecosystem.

This Knowledge Paper provides a comprehensive understanding of the Ministry's strategic priorities, institutional framework, flagship initiatives, policy landscape, and emerging opportunities across heritage conservation, museums, cultural infrastructure, creative industries, and international cultural cooperation. It also identifies avenues where CCI India can support investment, innovation, skill development, cultural entrepreneurship, digital transformation, and global outreach initiatives.

The publication serves as a valuable resource for policymakers, cultural institutions, industry leaders, investors, researchers, educational organizations, tourism stakeholders, and development agencies committed to preserving India's heritage while unlocking new avenues of economic and social development. Through informed dialogue and collaborative partnerships, it seeks to strengthen cultural institutions, generate employment, encourage innovation, and promote India's cultural excellence globally.

As India continues to celebrate its civilizational heritage while embracing modernization, collaborative efforts will remain essential in preserving and promoting its rich cultural legacy. CCI India remains committed to partnering with the Ministry of Culture in advancing heritage conservation, creative innovation, and sustainable cultural development.

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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PREFACE

The Ministry of Culture stands at the confluence of India's civilisational heritage and its aspirations for a creative, inclusive, and globally respected future. As India accelerates towards becoming a USD 5 trillion economy and, subsequently, a Viksit Bharat by 2047, the strategic leveraging of culture as an economic, diplomatic, and social resource has assumed unprecedented importance. This Knowledge Paper is a testament to the role that structured, analytical policy thinking can play in transforming the cultural sector from a heritage-preservation mandate into a dynamic engine of national development.

India's cultural landscape encompasses an extraordinary diversity from classical performing arts, handloom and handicraft traditions, and ancient monuments to emerging creative industries such as animation, gaming, cinema, and digital heritage. The Ministry of Culture, tasked with nurturing this vast ecosystem, operates at the intersection of preservation and promotion, education and enterprise, domestic identity and international engagement. Yet, despite its profound mandate, the Ministry's sectoral potential remains significantly under-realised in terms of investment mobilisation, private sector participation, and outcome-oriented governance.

It is precisely in this context that CCI India the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India envisions a transformative partnership with the Ministry of Culture. CCI India brings to this engagement a distinctive institutional capability: a nationwide network of industry leaders, startup ecosystems, investment communities, international trade linkages, and policy advocacy forums. This Knowledge Paper articulates a comprehensive, evidence-based framework for CCI India's strategic collaboration with the Ministry, identifying priority areas, flagship interventions, investment opportunities, and a five-year implementation roadmap.

This document is authored with the rigour of a professional policy advisory report and is intended for the consideration of Union Ministers, Secretaries to the Government of India, NITI Aayog, senior bureaucrats, industry leaders, investors, development agencies, and international institutions. It is our sincere hope that this Knowledge Paper catalyses a productive and sustained dialogue between CCI India and the Ministry of Culture one that results in tangible, measurable outcomes for India's cultural economy, its artisan communities, heritage institutions, and creative entrepreneurs.

CHAMBER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY OF INDIA (CCI INDIA)

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

SHRI NARENDRA MODI **2**

HONORABLE PRIME MINISTER, INDIA *2*

SHRI GAJENDRA SINGH SHEKAWAT **3**

HONORABLE MINISTER, ... *3*
MINISTRY OF CULTURE *3*

SHRI MUNINDRA KUMAR **4**

DIRECTOR GENERAL, CHAMBER OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRIES OF INDIA *4*

PREFACE **5**

ABOUT CCI INDIA **8**

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION TO THE MINISTRY OF CULTURE **9**

1.1 Constitutional and Institutional Mandate 9
1.2 Evolution and Governance Role 9
1.3 National Significance 9

SECTION 2: HISTORICAL TIMELINE OF THE MINISTRY **10**

2.1 Institutional Evolution: Key Milestones 10

SECTION 3: MINISTRY OVERVIEW & ORGANISATIONAL STRUCTURE **10**

3.1 Departmental Architecture 10

SECTION 4: STRATEGIC IMPORTANCE OF THE MINISTRY **11**

4.1 Economic Contribution of the Cultural Sector 11
4.2 Employment and Livelihood Impact 12
4.3 Social and Diplomatic Significance 12

SECTION 5: CULTURAL SECTOR LANDSCAPE IN INDIA **12**

5.1 Market Size and Structure 12
5.2 Key Stakeholders and Ecosystem Players 13

SECTION 6: MINISTRY PROGRESSIVE REVIEW(2020-2026) **13**

6.1 Progressive Review 13
6.2 Key Schemes and Performance 14

SECTION 7: CURRENT LANDSCAPE ANALYSIS **15**

7.1 Major Achievements 15
7.2 Existing Challenges 15
7.3 Global Benchmarking 15

SECTION 8: STRATEGIC NEED FOR CCI INDIA COLLABORATION **16**

8.1 Ecosystem Gaps Requiring Industry Partnership 16
8.2 Public-Private Partnership Imperative 16

SECTION 9: GAP ANALYSIS FRAMEWORK **17**

9.1 Strategic Gap Analysis 17

SECTION 10: OPPORTUNITY ASSESSMENT MATRIX **18**

10.1 Strategic Opportunities Ranked by Potential 18

SECTION 11: INNOVATION & ECOSYSTEM DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK **19**

11.1 CulTech: The Emerging Frontier 19
11.2 Creative Economy Innovation Ecosystem 20

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SECTION 12: STRATEGIC ROLE OF CCI INDIA 20

12.1 Institutional Positioning and Capabilities 20

SECTION 13: PROPOSED COLLABORATION FRAMEWORK 21

13.1 Strategic Objectives of the Partnership 21
13.2 Governance Structure 21
13.3 Centres of Excellence 22

SECTION 14: PROPOSED FLAGSHIP PROGRAMMES FOR CCI INDIA 22

14.1 Programme Portfolio 22

SECTION 15: INVESTMENT & FUNDING FRAMEWORK..... 24

15.1 Funding Architecture for Cultural Economy Development 24

SECTION 16: STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT PRIORITY MATRIX 25

16.1 Strategic Stakeholder FrameworK 25

SECTION 17: EXPECTED IMPACT ASSESSMENT..... 26

17.1 Projected Outcomes (2026–2031).....26

SECTION 18: FIVE-YEAR STRATEGIC ROADMAP (2026–2031) 27

18.1 Year-wise Implementation Plan 27

SECTION 19: WHY CCI INDIA IS THE IDEAL STRATEGIC PARTNER 28

19.1 Institutional Strengths Uniquely Suited to This Mandate 28

SECTION 20: STRATEGIC ACTION AGENDA & POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS..... 29

20.1 Immediate Priorities (2026–2027).....29
20.2 Medium-Term Priorities (2027–2029) 29
20.3 Long-Term Priorities (2029–2031).....30

CONCLUSION 31

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ABOUT CCI INDIA

CCI India (The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) is a premier national business chamber dedicated to fostering economic growth, industry development, entrepreneurship, innovation, and investment promotion across India. As the voice of Indian business and industry, CCI India serves as a bridge between government, industry, startups, academia, investors, and civil society, facilitating meaningful collaboration for nation-building and sustainable development.

Through policy advocacy, business facilitation, research, stakeholder engagement, capacity building, and strategic partnerships, CCI India works to create an enabling environment for enterprises of all sizes. The Chamber actively supports key national initiatives such as Startup India, Make in India, Digital India, Atmanirbhar Bharat, Skill India, and Viksit Bharat 2047 by connecting innovative enterprises with government opportunities and promoting inclusive economic development.

CCI India operates through sector-specific councils, industry forums, knowledge platforms, and state-level engagements that address emerging opportunities and challenges across sectors including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, healthcare, education, infrastructure, sustainability, MSMEs, and startups. The Chamber regularly organizes policy dialogues, investment summits, business delegations, workshops, conferences, and knowledge-sharing initiatives to strengthen India's economic ecosystem.

With a strong commitment to innovation, entrepreneurship, and public-private collaboration, CCI India strives to empower enterprises, facilitate investment, enhance competitiveness, and contribute to India's journey toward becoming a globally competitive and economically resilient nation. Its role as a knowledge partner and industry catalyst enables ministries, departments, state governments, startups, and businesses to collaborate effectively in achieving national development objectives.

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SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION TO THE MINISTRY OF CULTURE

1.1 Constitutional and Institutional Mandate

The Ministry of Culture derives its mandate from Entry 63 of the Union List of the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India, which assigns the Union Government responsibility for institutions of national importance in the fields of culture, history, and arts. This constitutional grounding confers upon the Ministry a unique national character and a responsibility that transcends administrative function it is the custodian of India's collective identity, civilisational memory, and creative expression.

Institutionally, the Ministry operates as the nodal agency for all matters relating to the preservation of cultural heritage, promotion of art forms, literary and performing arts, and international cultural exchanges. Its mandate encompasses the upkeep of centrally protected monuments, regulation of antiquities and art treasure, promotion of Indology, establishment and management of cultural institutions, and the implementation of national cultural policy.

1.2 Evolution and Governance Role

The Ministry of Culture, in its present form, has evolved through decades of institutional consolidation. Prior to 1985, cultural affairs were managed under the Ministry of Education. The establishment of a dedicated Ministry of Culture marked a significant policy statement recognising culture not merely as a subset of education but as a distinct and sovereign domain of national governance. Over subsequent decades, the Ministry's ambit expanded to incorporate digital heritage, cultural diplomacy, and creative economy dimensions, reflecting the evolving understanding of culture's role in national development.

The Ministry's governance role is multifaceted: it acts as a standard-setter through its akademis (national academies of arts, literature, music, and visual arts), a conservator through ASI and the National Archives, a promoter through its seven Zonal Cultural Centres and numerous festivals and events, and a diplomat through cultural exchange programmes under ICCR (Indian Council for Cultural Relations, though formally under MEA, collaborates closely). It also plays a regulatory role through the Antiquities and Art Treasures Act, 1972.

1.3 National Significance

The Ministry's national significance is deeply embedded in India's development narrative. Culture is the foundation upon which India's soft power rests the instrument through which the country projects its values, creativity, and identity to the world. In an era of cultural diplomacy and competitive nation-branding, the Ministry's work directly contributes to India's international standing, tourism economy, creative sector employment, and social cohesion. The 'Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat' programme, which the Ministry supports, exemplifies culture's role as a tool for national integration across India's extraordinary linguistic and ethnic diversity.

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SECTION 2: HISTORICAL TIMELINE OF THE MINISTRY

2.1 Institutional Evolution: Key Milestones

The Ministry of Culture's evolution reflects India's own journey from post-independence nation-building to contemporary global engagement. The timeline below captures the most significant milestones in the Ministry's institutional development, policy transformation, and programmatic expansion.

Year	Milestone / Reform	Significance
1947-1950	Cultural affairs under Ministry of Education	Foundation of cultural governance in independent India
1958	Establishment of ASI under statutory framework	Systematic conservation of India's archaeological heritage initiated
1961	Antiquities and Art Treasures Act enacted	Legal framework for protecting and regulating India's art heritage
1968	National Archives established as apex body	Centralised preservation of government and historical records
1954-1972	Establishment of Sangeet Natak, Lalit Kala, Sahitya Akademis	Institutional support for performing arts, visual arts, and literature
1985	Separate Ministry of Culture created	Cultural governance elevated as an independent national priority
1990s	National Culture Fund (NCF) established	PPP model introduced for monument conservation and restoration
2004-2014	Digital heritage initiatives commenced; PRASHAD scheme launched	Technology integration and pilgrimage tourism development accelerated
2015-2020	Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat; Dekho Apna Desh initiative	Culture as instrument of national integration and domestic tourism promotion
2021-2023	India G20 Presidency; Cultural corridors announced	Culture elevated in India's international diplomatic and economic agenda
2024-2026	Creative Economy Mission; Digital India Culture Square	Technology-driven cultural economy development as national priority

SECTION 3: MINISTRY OVERVIEW & ORGANISATIONAL STRUCTURE

3.1 Departmental Architecture

The Ministry of Culture operates through a sophisticated institutional architecture comprising its core secretariat, attached offices, subordinate offices, autonomous bodies, and grant-in-aid institutions. This structure enables both centralised policy direction and decentralised programme execution across India's diverse cultural landscape.

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